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Population Growth and Problems in India: A Geographical Study

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Introduction

Since ancient times, the world's population has been continuously increasing. Due to the increasing population, many social, economic, cultural, political and environmental problems are arising in the world. These problems vary depending on the place and time. The nature of the population of a country depends on the number of resources in the country. If the population is more than the availability of resources, that population is called excess population e.g. India, China, Pakistan and Bangladesh. Geographical study of population characteristics of a region is of important for understanding its dynamism as well as for planning at the local and regional level. In increase or decrease in the population may bring about a versatile change in the man-land ratio, distribution and composition of population. Population as resources become the Population distribution, density, sex ratio, literacy rate, literates, growth rate etc. depends on quantity and

qualities of population. The study is mainly concerned with association between population characteristics and geographical factors. Population distribution, density is dependent upon the geographical condition of that particular area. The demographic characteristics, such as growth, density and sex structure, literacy and occupational structure play a very important role in the socio-economic development of any region. Population structure describes the socio-economic and demographic features of an area. Man is the single most important powerful geographical factor transforming the earth surface at an unparalleled speed (Husain, 1999). Thus, the spatio-temporal distribution of human population and its structure has become one of the important of the study in an area like population growth rate, density, literacy and sex ratio choose the demographic characteristics. Population structure is describing the various socio-economic and demographic features of

an area. Thus, need have study in demographic characteristics are number of purposes, policy makers, planners and administrators.

The development of population during education and occupational guidance should consequently accord a very high precedence in the prospect planning and programmed of economic development. Population has both quantitative and qualitative scope. The characteristics like the size composition and distribution of population and skilled labour force, literacy level, the number of hours worked the output and earnings per head. Population is one of the important of a region. The qualitative and quantitative evaluation of human resources is thus vital to know the process of development in a region.

Population Growth in India:

The history of population growth in India shows fluctuations in different periods. India ranks second in the world in terms of population after China. The history of Indian population growth in the 20th century is generally divided into three periods. In it, the period of stable population, the period of increasing population and the period of rapidly increasing population are divided. The first stable population period is between 1901 and 1921. In 1901, the population of India was 23.6 crore, which reached 24.8 crore in the twenty years up to 1921. During this period, the birth rate was high along with the death rate. The death rate was high due to frequent droughts, epidemics and typhus. Due to this the natural increase (1.2 crore) in the total population of India decreased significantly. In the decade from 1901 to 1911, the population growth was 5.73 percentages, while in the decade from

1911 to 1921 it was - 0.31 percentages. But the period after 1921 became the decisive stage of the division of the Indian population, because after 1921, the population of India continued to increase. The thirty-year period from 1921 to 1951 is known as the period of population growth. In 1921, the population of India was 248 million, which increased to 360 million in 1951.

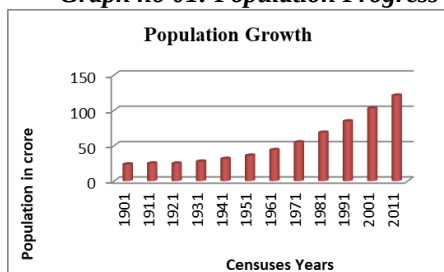
Table No 01: Indian population growth (1901-2011)

Censuses Years	Population in crore	Changes in Population
1901	23.6	--
1911	24.9	5.75
1921	24.8	-0.31
1931	27.6	11
1941	31.5	14.22
1951	36	13.31
1961	43.9	21.64
1971	54.8	24.80
1981	68.5	24.66
1991	84.5	23.87
2001	102.8	21.54
2011	121.02	17.64

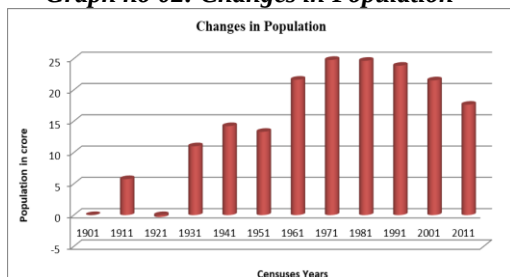
In the entire thirty years, the population increased by 112 million. During this period, the rate of population growth increased from -0.31 percentages (1921) to 13.31 percentages (1951). The death rate decreased due to the elimination of epidemic diseases, overcoming drought, improvement in medical facilities and improvement in transport and communication facilities. Along with economic development, progress in the agricultural sector led to an increase in food grain production, due to which the death rate, which was 47 per thousand in 1921, came down to 27 per thousand in 1951, but the birth rate, however,

increased to about 40 per thousand, leading to an increase in the population. The year 1951 is considered a decisive year in the history of India's population growth. Because of the significant changes have taken place in India's population in the period after 1951. The period from 1951 to 2001 is known as the period of rapid population growth in the history of Indian population. In 1951, India's population was 36 crores, which increased to 102.8 crore in 2001. In the entire fifty-year period, the population increased by 66.8 crore (more than double). During this period, the population growth rate averaged more than 2 percent every year. The process of development that reached every corner of the country, food supply, and increase in medical facilities and improved standard of living led to a significant reduction in the death rate.

Graph no 01: Population Progress



Graph no 02: Changes in Population



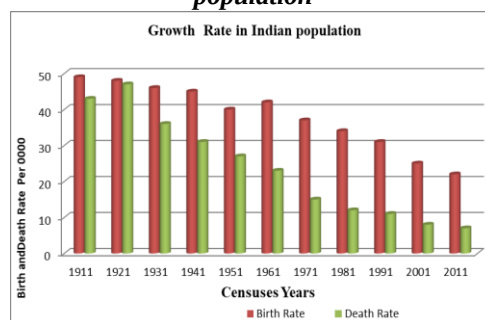
The death rate of 27 per thousand in 1951 came down to 8 in 2001. However, the birth rate of 40 per thousand in 1951 came down

to only 25 in 2001. Due to the difference in birth rate and death rate, the population of India grew explosively during this period.

Table No 02: Natural Growth in Indian population (1911- 2021)

Censuses Years	Birth Rate (Per Thousand)	Death Rate (Per Thousand)	Natural Growth
1911	49	43	06
1921	48	47	01
1931	46	36	10
1941	45	31	14
1951	40	27	13
1961	42	23	19
1971	37	15	23
1981	34	12	22
1991	31	11	20
2001	25	08	17
2011	22	07	15

Graph no 03: Growth Rate in Indian population



Population Problem in India

After independence, continuous efforts were made in India for population control. But the desired success in population control was not achieved. As a result, the following problems have arisen due to the increase in population.

1. Unemployment:

India is an agricultural country. According to the statistics of 2011, 61.5 percent of the people in India depend on

agriculture. However, due to the increase in the use of modern technology in agriculture, employment opportunities have decreased. Due to this, the problem of unemployment of the population associated with the agricultural sector arises. Despite the desire, qualification and readiness to work in the available wages, the young population of the country does not get a job / business. Due to unemployment, over-unemployment and seasonal unemployment in the country, the young class is attracted to foreign employment. Due to this, a large-scale brain drain problem arises.

2. Poverty:

Poverty is the condition of people who are unable to meet their basic needs. Along with the increasing population in India, the population below the poverty line is increasing. Per capita income is low due to low pace of industrialization, low productivity of agriculture, and increasing unemployment. As a result, poverty increases. In India, 29.9 percent are below the poverty line in 2011-12. The state with the highest population below the poverty line in India is Jharkhand, while the lowest is Goa.

3. Economic inequality:

In India, the problems of poverty and unemployment have arisen due to economic inequality. Out of the total national expenditure in India, 15 percent of the amount is spent by only 30 percent of the rich. Many efforts are made at the government level to eradicate poverty. But the gap between the rich and the poor has not reduced yet.

4. Increase in dependency ratio:

Along with the increasing population in India, the dependency ratio of the

population has also become a major problem in India's economic development. Due to the increase in the birth rate, the burden of feeding the additional population falls on the working population, the products produced by the working people are spent on the non-working population, thus slowing down the pace of economic progress.

5. Increasing pace of urbanization:

Rural-urban migration occurs due to the decrease in employment opportunities in rural areas. Every year, a large number of young people migrate to urban areas in order to get employment. Due to this, the pace of urbanization has increased in India. For example, the pace of urbanization in India was 23.3 percent in 1981 and it was 31.6 percent in 2011.

6. Migration:

The highly educated and intelligent youth of India do not get employment, high salary range, scope for research and necessary facilities for research according to their qualifications. As a result, such people migrate to other countries. The benefit of the expenditure made to produce intelligent people in their own country is gained by other countries due to migration. Due to this, the technological progress and subsequent economic progress of the country are hampered. Also, in recent times, due to migration from rural areas to urban areas, rural areas are becoming deserted and problems are increasing due to population growth in urban areas.

7. Decrease in land holding area:

The population in India is continuously increasing but the land area is stable. As a result, there is a decrease in land holding area. In 2010-11, the land

holding area per capita in India was 1.15 hectares, which came down to 1.08 hectares in 2015-16. The decrease in land holding area has an adverse effect on the growth of output.

8. Fragmentation of agricultural land:

In India, agricultural land owned by families is divided equally by inheritance. Due to the ever-increasing population, the land is fragmented and the size of the farms becomes smaller. There are limitations on the use of modern tools and techniques in these small-sized farms. A large amount of agricultural land is wasted in the embankments of the farms. As a result, production decreases.

9. Regional imbalance:

The process of development is uneven in different regions of India. This creates regional imbalance. Geographical, economic, social and cultural factors are responsible for regional imbalance. But in regions with economic prosperity, the population is concentrated and the backward areas are deserted. Regional imbalance has adverse effects on the economic, social and cultural situation of the country.

10. Declining standard of living:

The growth of population in India is leading to a decline in per capita income. As a result, the standard of living has deteriorated. Population growth leads to a shortage of food with sufficient and necessary calories, which leads to malnutrition and other health problems. To overcome this, expenditure has to be made on medical facilities.

11. Additional stress on infrastructure:

The increase in population has created additional stress on infrastructure such as

transport and communication, education, health, water supply. The government has to make huge financial provisions to create infrastructure. As a result, the development process is stagnating as most of the funds are spent on infrastructure facilities.

12. Increasing pressure on resources:

The pressure of additional population on natural resources such as soil, water, minerals, plants and animals are increasing day by day. While the resources are on the verge of depletion, the use of chemical fertilizers for more production from resources like soil has created problems like soil pollution, water pollution. The decreasing number of elements like forest resources creates many problems.

13. Social unrest:

Increasing urbanization, poverty and unemployment in India have led to a large amount of social unrest. Due to unemployment, incidents like depression, addiction, theft, robbery, robbery and violence against women increase in criminal tendencies and create unrest.

14. Decrease in per capita income:

Due to the large population of India, the national product of the country is divided, due to which the per capita income is low and the standard of living deteriorates. The savings rate of the people decreases. This has an adverse effect on investment, production and employment generation and the unemployment rate increases. Compared to developed countries, India's per capita income is very low.

Along with the above problems, economic and social problems like slow industrial growth, decline in the working

capacity of the population, traditionalism, pollution, backwardness in planning, population explosion, more imports than exports have arisen in India due to the excess population. Also, environmental problems like deforestation, energy crises, air pollution, water pollution and soil pollution have arisen before India.

Conclusion:

The increasing population of the country does not become the problem of the country, but the age structure of the population creates the problem of the population. Due to the increasing birth rate, the unproductive population is added to the population. Due to this, the dependency burden increases. It has an adverse effect on the economic development of the country.

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